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# THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp ★★★★★ THURSDAY, OCTOBER 22, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVIII NO. 96 WSJ.com ★★★★ $5.00

DJIA 52856.09 ▲ 360.21 0.69% NASDAQ 26702.86 ▲ 1.1% STOXX 600 644.49 ▲ 0.9% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 7/32, yield 5.145% OIL $97.15 ▼ $0.67 GOLD $4,130.50 ▲ $8.10 EURO $1.1233 YEN 158.14


## What's News

### *Business & Finance*

◆ **The Nasdaq is** trouncing the NYSE in the competition for the biggest IPOs and Anthropic is expected to bring the tech-heavy exchange another blockbuster listing. **A1, B10**

◆ **Elon Musk signaled** his interest in uniting SpaceX and Tesla in what would be the biggest corporate merger of all-time. **A1**

◆ **Musk said Tesla could** be ready to start shipping its Optimus humanoid robots by the end of next year and that its fleet of autonomous taxis will soon become a significant driver of revenue. **B1**

◆ **Big names in AI** helped lift major U.S. stock indexes, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow rising 0.6%, 1.1% and 0.7%, respectively. **B11**

◆ **AT&T lifted its** full-year profit outlook and again reported quarterly revenue growth, but disappointed some investors with its core wireless-subscriber numbers and rising expenses. **B3**

◆ **Abbott plans to** hive off its embattled nutrition business by the end of next year, a separation it said would allow both companies to direct resources more effectively. **B5**

◆ **Akzo Nobel is in** talks with buyers to sell its European vehicle-refinishing business, seeking to secure regulatory clearance for its proposed merger with U.S. peer Axalta. **B6**

◆ **Carrefour shares fell** after the grocer cut its profitability targets for the year as it expects the protests in France to cast a pall over sales. **B3**

◆ **Hudbay Minerals** and Mitsubishi formally approved construction of a major copper mine in Arizona. **B5**

### *Worldwide*

◆ **Artificial-intelligence** tools helped to uncover a critical security issue that could be leveraged by hackers to take control of any system running software provided by PHP, a technology that powers as much as 70% of the world's websites. **A1**

◆ **Lawmakers from both** parties called for an investigation into Elon Musk after The Wall Street Journal reported that he restricted Ukraine's access to the company's Starlink network. **A8**

◆ **New Mexico sued** Epstein's longtime lawyer and accountant, accusing them of helping finance and conceal their late client's sex trafficking at his Zorro Ranch in the state. **A3**

◆ **An attack ad against** an Ohio Democrat featuring her estranged mother calling her a liar and unfit for office roiled the state's closely contested governor race. **A4**

◆ **Trump called on** companies that build data centers to make their own electricity and pay communities a dividend when constructing the sites to blunt local opposition. **A6**

◆ **New York Democrat** Brad Lander said he was briefly detained and released by the Israeli military while he was helping Palestinian farmers with a harvest in the occupied West Bank. **A4**

◆ **Middle East mediators** strove to revive talks with Iran, fearful that hostilities could flare again as the U.S. and Israel make actual and rhetorical shows of force. **A7**

◆ **Died: Kyle Francis Kennedy**, 42, a granddaughter of Robert F. Kennedy. **A4**


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# Russia Frees American Held Captive Since 2022



**LIBERATED:** Stephen Hubbard, second from left in front, who was arrested by Russia early in its invasion of Ukraine, was headed back to the U.S. Wednesday. After the release, U.S. envoy Steve Witkoff told Vladimir Putin: 'You are a humanitarian.' **A8**

# Kremlin Steps Up Sabotage In Europe

By Bojan Pancevski

BERLIN—A massive cargo plane, used to carry military assistance to Ukraine and parked at an airfield in eastern Germany, was attacked by explosive-packed drones in early August. German officials said they were piloted by Russian military-intelligence agents.

One drone slammed into the Antonov freighter but failed to explode. Another collided with a different plane, and a third detonated near the airport perimeter, authorities said. Had the assault worked as planned, investigators said, the result would have been mayhem and casualties at one of Europe's most important air-cargo airports.

U.S. intelligence agencies said the failed operation at Leipzig-Halle Airport this summer was one of the opening shots in a stepped-up campaign of sabotage and covert action against NATO countries ordered directly by President Vladimir Putin of Russia, European officials briefed on their findings said.

Russia's intensified campaign comes as Ukrainian forces, with European support, have largely fought the Russian army to a standstill on the ground, inflicting heavy losses and preventing significant territorial gains over the

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# SpaceX, Tesla Explore Formalizing Their Ties

By Becky Peterson And Corrie Driebusch

Elon Musk has engineered ties between Tesla and SpaceX that are hard to break, and now he wants to fuse them together permanently.

Musk has run both Tesla and SpaceX concurrently over the past two decades, using a schedule that dictated which days he spent focused on each business.

The companies have often shared resources and personnel, signaling their close ties. Last year, SpaceX looked into creating a space suit for Tesla's humanoid robot Optimus, a person familiar with the matter said. Tesla last week showed off its new Roadster, a vehicle featuring SpaceX rocket thrusters that it hopes to soon bring to market.

And in recent months, Musk has repositioned both companies by expanding beyond their core operations toward a shared mission centered around artificial intelligence.

The world's richest man signaled on Tuesday his interest in tying up SpaceX and Tesla, marking what would be the biggest corporate merger of all time. Serving as chief executive of SpaceX and Tesla, Musk said committees of independent directors at both companies are evaluating a possible deal, adding that a transaction might not come to fruition.

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◆ **Tesla aims to sell robots next year..... B1**
◆ **Big names help break tech-stock malaise..... B11**


# AI Finds Bug That Puts Most Websites At Risk

## Patch is rushed out in mad effort to fix vulnerability before hackers exploit it

By Robert McMillan

Artificial-intelligence tools helped find one of the most severe online bugs ever, setting off a scramble to fix a problem that puts up to 70% of the world's websites at risk of being exploited by hackers.

The creators of PHP, a technology that powers as much as 70% of the world's websites, disclosed a critical security issue Wednesday that could be leveraged by hackers to take control of any system running its software. That would allow an attacker to steal information or launch a cyberattack on anyone visiting a hacked website.

Security researchers found the vulnerability using AI. Now web administrators are scrambling to protect themselves from the vulnerability, which cutting-edge AI systems could quickly exploit.

Some government and commercial site operators said they pre-emptively took their sites offline, and reports of attempted cyberattacks began circulating on Wednesday.

The issue, dubbed PHP2Shell, represents a class of problems in the way PHP manages a computer's memory. It can be exploited in many ways, some requiring just a few seconds, by hackers who could use it to run unauthorized software on any unpatched web server.

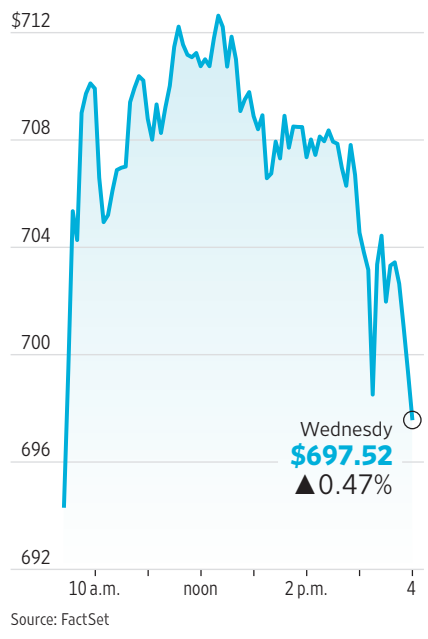
It is the most severe security issue that PHP has faced in more than a decade, according

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## Penalty, Then a Record For Meta

A New Mexico judge ordered Meta Platforms to pay $25 billion, weeks after a jury found the social-media company misled users about its data-privacy practices. Separately, Meta reported record revenue for the quarter and said it would create a new class of nonvoting stock linked to its AI needs. **A3, B1**

**Meta Platforms share price on Wednesday**




Source: FactSet

# NYSE Is Losing Fight for Big IPOs

By Corrie Driebusch

The New York Stock Exchange and Nasdaq have spent years trying to outdo each other as they compete for the hottest new listings, pitching companies on their ability to generate buzz and offering goodies such as billboards and lavish galas.

Lately, it isn't much of a fight.

The Nasdaq stock exchange has won listings of 59 companies, raising nearly $120 billion in traditional IPOs so far this year through Friday, according to Dealogic, while the NYSE has landed 32 companies, raising $20 billion.

Of Nasdaq's haul, $86 billion comes from SpaceX, the biggest IPO in history. It could add a further $100 billion or so to its tally if artificial-intelligence giant Anthropic officially selects Nasdaq for its planned IPO next month.

Some NYSE officials privately grouse Nasdaq's decision to fast-track the addition of large newly public companies like SpaceX to its popular Nasdaq-100 index made it all but impossible to compete.

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◆ **Longer NYSE trading hours herald industry shift..... B10**

## *Golden Ticket, Nosebleed Seats: Offer Has Brewers Fans Fuming*

* * *

Holders of 'timeless tickets' couldn't wait to cash in. They may need binoculars.

By Jared Diamond

Danny Fochesato wanted to treat himself for his 27th birthday back in January 2015, and he had the perfect gift. His beloved Milwaukee Brewers had just launched a promotion unlike any other in American professional sports—and it sounded too good to be true.

"Whoa," Fochesato thought, "this can't be real."

Fochesato is one of 1,000 people who spent $1,000 nearly a dozen years ago for what the Brewers called a "timeless ticket." This special pass granted holders the right to attend a single home game of their choosing at any point in the future. The package included a one-pound brass ticket engraved with the owner's name.

To those who have one, like Emily Mae Heller, "It's like getting Willy Wonka's golden ticket."

The time has come to cash in. The Brewers are in the World Series for the first time since 1982. They will host the Tampa Bay Rays for Game 1 on Friday as they begin their bid for the franchise's first

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*Fool's gold*

# Autism Therapy's 'Business Math'

## Data show some private-equity-backed chains billed far more hours than rivals

Minutes after an autistic 3-year-old lay her head on a Squishmallow stuffed toy and closed her eyes, Abigayle Hosking was ordered to take the makeshift pillow

*By **Anna Wilde Mathews, Christopher Weaver** and **Tom McGinty***

away and rouse the sleepy girl. The child was scheduled for four more hours of autism therapy at the Centria Healthcare clinic in Michigan where Hosking worked until last year.

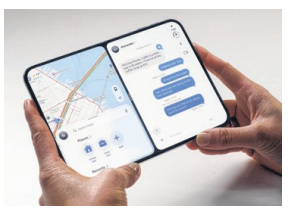
Hosking said she felt terrible. "The younger kids, you know, I think they need a break," she said.

Medicaid plans and private insurers will often pay for up to about 40 hours of autism therapy a week, and shut-eye doesn't count. At Centria and some other large chains backed by private-equity investors, former employees said in interviews that they felt pressure to maximize therapy hours, claims the companies dispute.

The Wall Street Journal analyzed the billings of five of the largest private equity-backed providers of autism therapy to Medicaid patients, including Centria. Together, the group's average

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## INSIDE



**PERSONAL JOURNAL**
Apple's folding Duo phone? Too much iPhone, too little iPad. **A10**



**BUSINESS & FINANCE**
A producer self-funded a $45 million Nicolas Cage movie. Then it went missing. **B1**